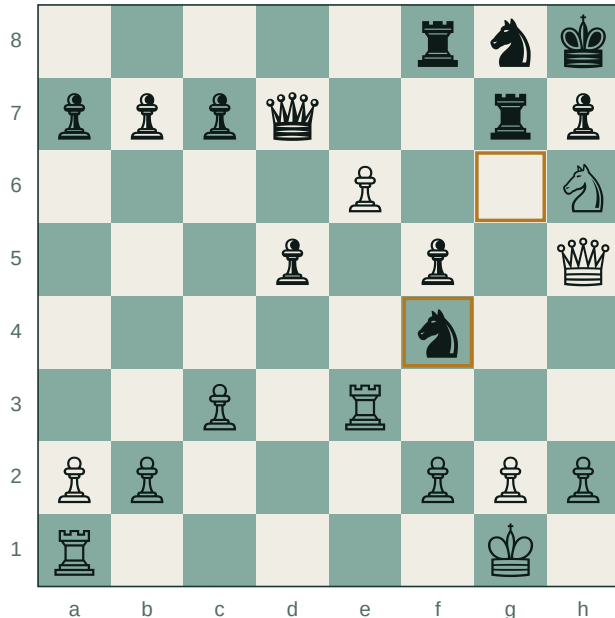


Clearance tactics: White, move 24

Clearance tactics

White to move



Previous move: 23...Nf4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

24. exd7 Nxh5 25. Re8 Rxd7 26. Rxf8

24.exd7 The pawn captures the queen on d7. Recorded reply: **24...Nxh5**.

25.Re8 The rook moves from e3 to e8. Recorded reply: **25...Rxd7**.

26.Rxf8 The rook captures the rook on f8.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -2 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on h8. Geometrically undefended: rook on f8 and knight on f4. Check for tactical protection.